



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 06: Relevance of Public Speaking

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Relevance Theory

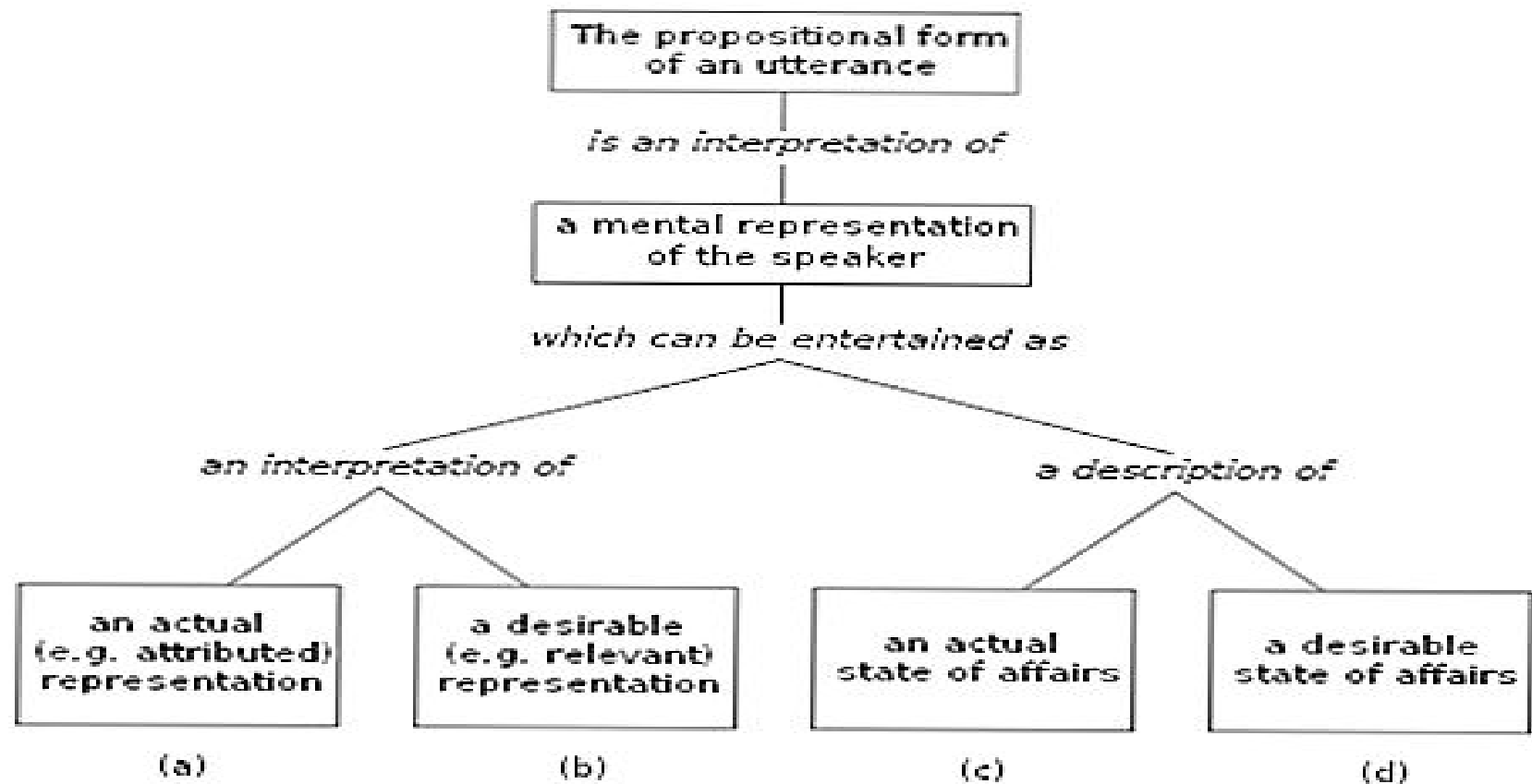
- Relevance theory, as proposed by **Sperber** and **Wilson** (*Relevance: Communication and Cognition*) claims that the search for relevance is a fundamental feature of human communication.
- According to this principle of relevance in communication, an input (a sight, a sound, an utterance, a memory) holds relevance to an individual only when its processing delivers **positive cognitive effects** – i.e. adds to his knowledge on a topic, clarifies a doubt, strengthens, revises or discards his pre-suppositions, and helps him arrive at a true and worthwhile conclusion about the topic.



Contd. ...

- Relevance is a function of **cognitive effect** and **processing effort** of the hearer.
- The degree of relevance is inversely proportional to the processing effort required by the hearer to handle the information in order to arrive at purposeful conclusions.
- Simultaneously, greater the positive cognitive effects an input has on the receiver, greater will be its relevance.
- Thus, owing to the significance of relevance in human communication, the speaker is required to produce stimuli that seems to the audience worthy enough to be processed and yields profitable outcomes.





Contd...

- “to be understood, and to make his audience think or act according to what is to be understood” (Sperber et al., 2010, p.364).

A speaker who intends an utterance to be interpreted in a particular way must also expect the hearer to be able to supply a context which allows that interpretation to be recovered. A mismatch between the context envisaged by the speaker and the one actually used by the hearer may result in a misunderstanding. (Sperber & Wilson, 1995, p.16)

*Ostensive-
inferential
Communication*

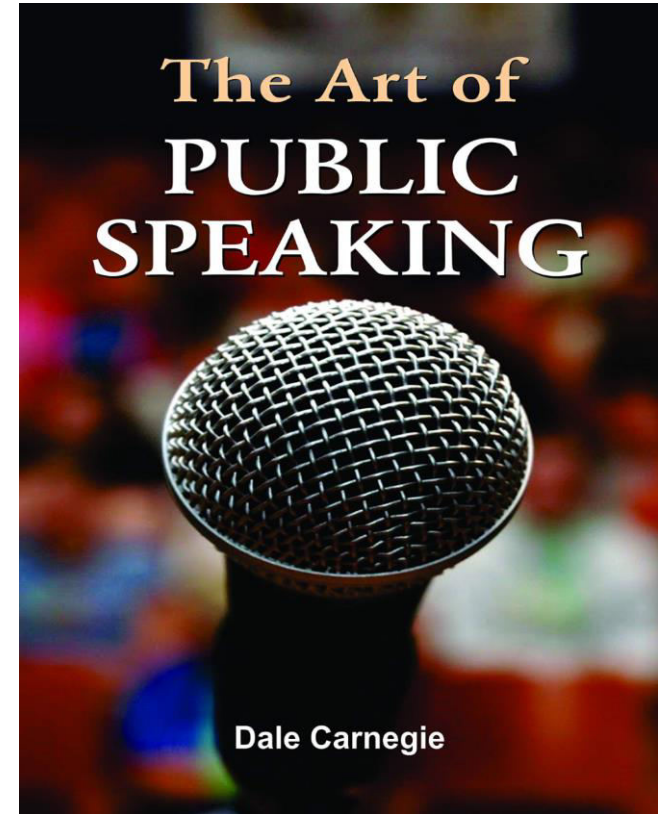
*Explicature
Implicature*

Eloquence: A Survival Skill

- Eloquence has sustained its significance as a highly prized skill globally as well as perennially.
- Humans revel in their higher pedestal among all other life forms owing to their rationale and sophisticated system of communication.
- Surveys establish the fact that we spend approximately 75 % of our conscious time in some form of communicative activity - i.e. LSRW, out of which oral communication or speaking in public forms a major chunk.
- The art of responsible speech communication - either as rhetoric, art, or behavioural science - plays a crucial role as an agent of social recognition in the modern pluralistic society.



- There has been a perpetual rise in the establishment of communication departments offering courses and training in public speaking in colleges, universities and professional organizations across the world.
- **Elwood Murray** sums up the significance of eloquence defining, speech as *“a tool of social adjustment which reflects the efficient personality.”*



An Imperative Need

- Public Speaking as a skill has popularly been associated with people of renown and civic or political import - for example, leaders, social activists, preachers, politicians and media personnels.
- Nevertheless, we are faced with numerous situations of public speaking in our everyday life, and we hear the phrase echoing in our ears **“Now, it’s your turn to speak”**.
- This skill therefore becomes an indispensable art to be harnessed for growth and success in all the realms - personal, professional, civic and the digital.



Public Speaking Adds Perks to the Personality

- **Boosts Confidence** - Public Speaking helps to significantly boost one's confidence by overcoming the fears that are associated with it. It also adds to the self-worth to the speaker as it provides recognition and acceptance of his/her ideas by the audience.
- **Critical Thinking** - Preparing and conducting public speeches calls for an exercise to the critical thinking faculty of the brain. Curating the speech for the audience, adding relevance to the message, organizing the thought in a coherent manner - all of it requires careful critical thinking.



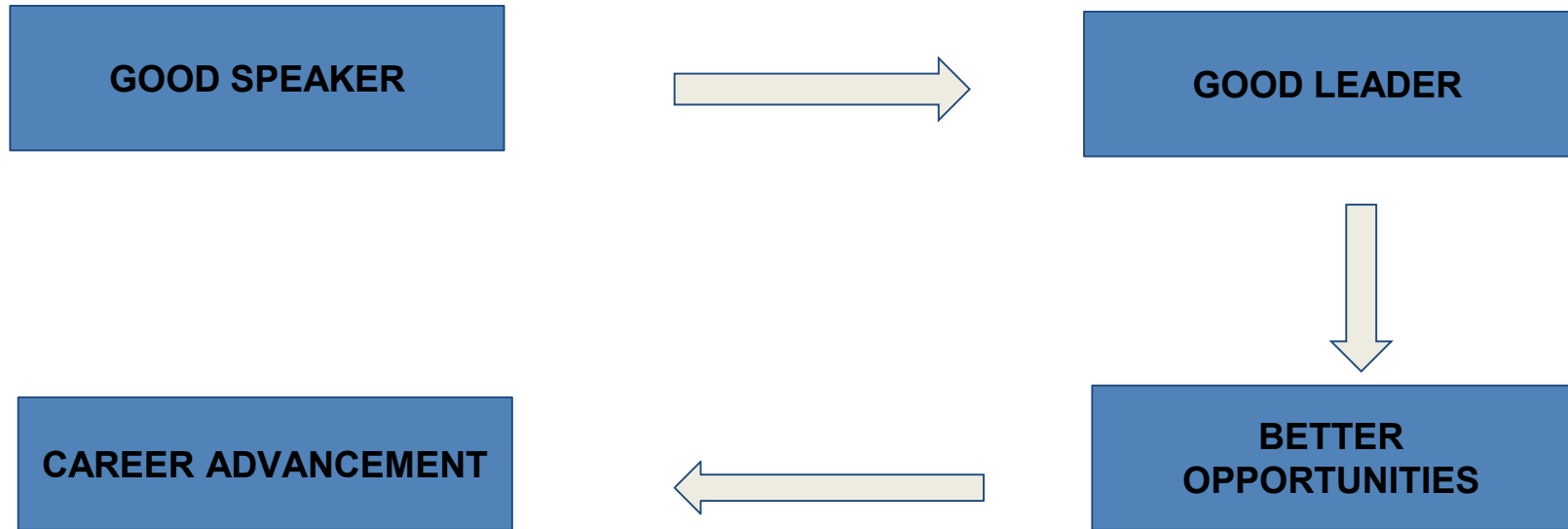
- **Improves Communication Skills** – One’s oratory performance hones both verbal as well as non-verbal communication skills of the speaker. It expands the vocabulary, improvises the manner of articulation, and thus moulds one into a fluent and immaculate speaker. It develops the temperament of becoming a better listener, to be able to calmly tolerate opposing views and defend one’s own.
 - **Personal Development** - Mastering the art of public speaking adds a remarkable flair to the personality of the speaker.
- ❑ *“Nothing in life is more important than the ability to communicate effectively.” (U.S. President, Gerald Ford)*

Public Speaking as a Professional Need

- ❑ Public speaking is a vital skill that bears an enormous impact on success in the professional sphere.
- **Carve a Niche** - Being a good speaker enables one to stand out at the workspace with confidence and to showcase the skills when others avoid such opportunities out of fear of public speaking.
- **Expand Professional Network** - Public speaking offers an array of opportunities to build up advantageous social connections and business contacts via conferences, meetings and other such forums.
- **Career Advancement** - The expertise of eloquence in the workspace is directly proportional to one's professional growth. Public Speaking skills helps to outshine others while exhibiting creativity, leadership, critical thinking and expertise.



- **Leadership Skills** - Speaking in public gives the power to persuade an audience towards an idea or a cause, thereby, promoting leadership qualities.



Most Important Skills for Graduates



Source: <https://www.aacu.org/sites/default/files/files/LEAP/2018EmployerResearchReport.pdf>



Public Speaking has been ranked first among the personal qualities of college graduates sought by employers across various public and private institutions.



A Tool for Social Change

- ❖ **Credibility** - The speaker arouses the passion of the audience by buying credibility for himself through his powerful speech delivery.
- ❖ **Speedy Broadcast** - In comparison to other tools of social media or print media, public speaking enables a faster communication of ideas and a more emphatic delivery of message.
- ❖ **Persuasive Appeal** - Of all the communicative avenues, speaking happens to be the most convincing and compelling force in order to drive a serious change. The message appears livelier when one campaigns for the cause to a live audience via public speaking.



Public Speaking: A Media Tool

In the contemporary digital world, mass media emerges as the giant of public communication. Public Speaking is being constructively used as a media tool in the digital world.

Informative Tool	Persuasive Tool	Entertainment Tool
Public Speaking is instrumental in disseminating knowledge - both academic and professional. Examples: Lectures, Talk-Shows, Ted Talks.	Public Speaking is remarkable in generating and influencing public opinion. Examples: Formal Speeches, Political Debates, BBC Interviews.	Public Speaking is often used as a tool for entertainment of the audience. Examples: Stand-up Comedies, Poetry Recitation .



The Credo of Responsible Oration

- In the wake of the enormous significance accorded to the skill of Public Speaking in personal, social and professional spheres, one needs to cultivate an attitude of being a responsible speaker.
- The fundamental ***Right to Speech*** (Article 19_Constitution of India) implicitly entails the fundamental duty of being an enlightened practitioner of the art of rhetoric in a democratic society:



- To accept the role of well-informed, unprejudiced, judicious articulators
- To express tolerance, respect for feedback, caution with language, precision, and ethics in public speaking
- To defend the speech rights of the opponents in case of a disagreement/debate
- To enjoy the liberty of speech with an acute sense of responsibility



“He who wants to persuade should put his trust not in the right argument, but in the right word. The power of sound has always been greater than the power of sense.”

Joseph Conrad

Thank You



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Lecture 07: Audience Awareness and Creating Credibility

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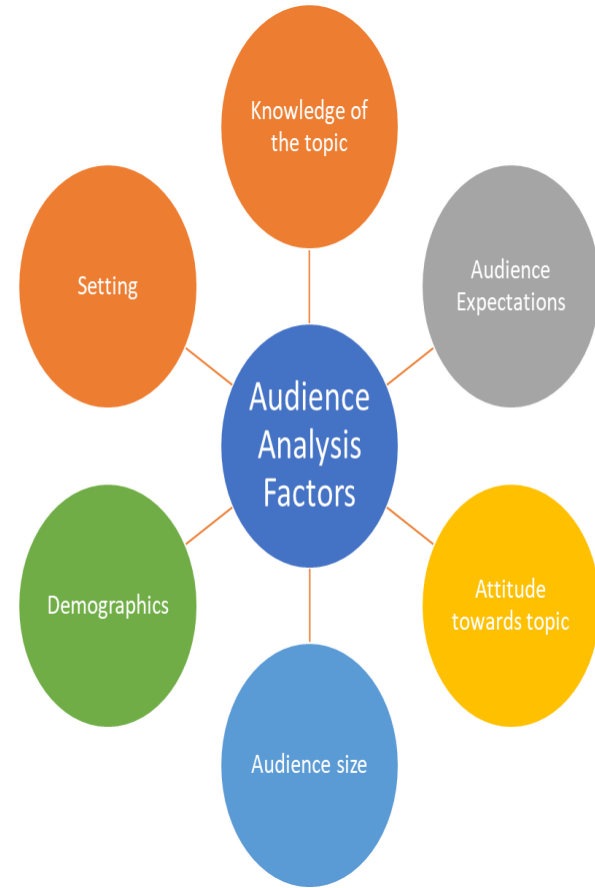
Awareness as a Speaker

- The aim of any speaker is to gain a **desired response** from the audience
- Questions that should be asked by the speaker to himself/herself before any communication is established-
 - ☐ To whom is s/he speaking?
 - ☐ What is the purpose?
 - ☐ What is the desired outcome of the speaker's delivery?
 - ☐ What can be the most effective manner of presenting the speech in order to accomplish the decided aim?

Audience Analysis

A good public speaker knows the difference between “over-adapting” and “under-adapting” while taking audience preferences into consideration.

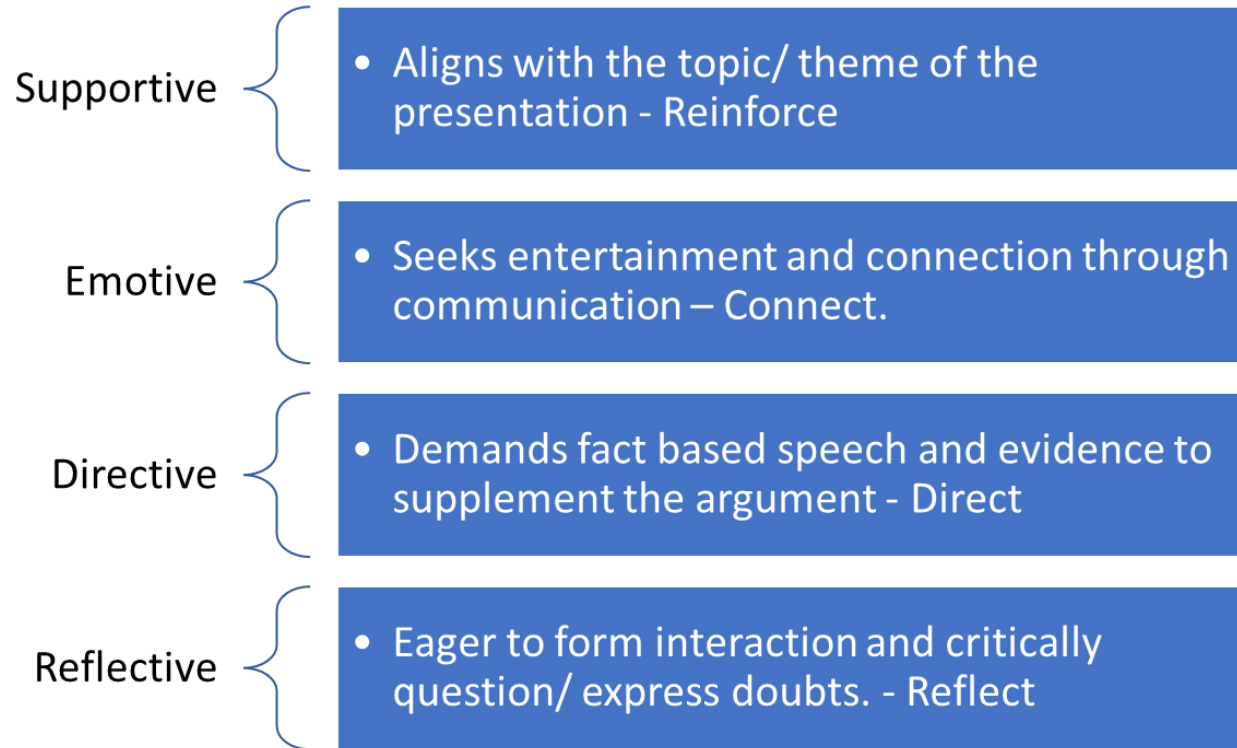
“There is a general agreement that a person who is a full member of a crowd... is likely to behave differently from the way he would behave if he were by himself.”(W.J. H. Sprott, Human Groups)



Awareness- A Conscious Space for Choice

- A speaker who is aware of the choices being made, takes into consideration all the following intricacies-
 - ☐ Selecting a topic
 - ☐ Determining a specific purpose
 - ☐ Settling on main points and supporting materials
 - ☐ Organizing message
 - ☐ Delivering the speech

Types of Audience



Classification of Audience

H.L. Hollingworth in his book, *The Psychology of Audience* :

- ❖ Pedestrian
- ❖ Discussion-passive
- ❖ Selective
- ❖ Concerted
- ❖ Organized

Demographics of Audience

Age.
Gender,
Education
Language,
Ethnicity
Culture
Attitudes & Values

Some Facts about Behavior in Group

- “Heightening of emotionality”
- “People in group have a reduced sense of responsibility.”
(W.J.H Sprott, Human Groups)
- ‘Group Size increases, member satisfaction decreases’ (A.P. Hare)
- Groups are collections of heterogeneous individuals.

Controlling Factors

- Variety
- Length of time concentration
- Time of the day
- Arousal and motivation

Content Creation with Audience Awareness

Step 1 - Prepare basic outline for the concerned talk/event.

Step 2 - Research on the type of audience.

Step 3 - Make the prepared outline focused with respect to the needs and interest of the audience.

Step 4 - Consider following to modify and strengthen yourself:

- ❖ Knowledge of the audience.
- ❖ Emotional state of the audience.
- ❖ Novelty/ Familiarity of the topic to the audience.
- ❖ Interpersonal relationship with the audience.

Stylistic Effect on Audience

- Irrespective of the novel content and solid argument, the style of a public speaker determines the captivating impact s/he has on the audience.
- A responsible orator would take care of following elements to appropriate their style with respect to the audience.
 - **Message:** with respect to audience's interests and needs
 - **Argument:** with respect to the need of strong evidence and narrative.
 - **Language:** with respect to the expected formality.
 - **Utterance** (Length and type): with respect to the time duration.
 - **Tone:** with respect to the interpersonal relationship.

Psychology of Audience

- It is essential for the speaker to make the audience **choose** to listen.
- Keeping the interest of the audience intact throughout is challenging.
- Response to any communication is not based entirely on what is spoken but especially on the **understanding of the audience.**
- The **basis of judgement** for the audience is what **they already know and believe.**
- The **message** should always be related to the audience- they should find it **as relevant as the speaker does.**

“ Without an audience women relapse and men become unkempt.”(Hollingsworth)

Patterns

Polarization
Interstimulation
Bipolar

Classmates as Audience

- Classroom is often considered as **artificial speaking situation**
- One can develop speaking skills within the classroom and can use it in the outside world
- Classroom can provide opportunity to inform and persuade same age group as well as elder people
- No immediate impact can mostly be registered but it can nourish one's speaking ability profusely



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Client as Audience



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- “Because it is what I like”- this is not a competent strategy
- Being Demonstrative is essential when dealing with client
- Know the difference between Prospect and Client

Addressing the Diversity

1. The talent of the speaker essentially relies in presenting the curated content in a polite and socially acceptable manner.
 - a. Recognize cultural filter of the audience.
 - b. Be aware of cultural gestures.
 - c. Use people-first language.

Example: Instead of saying “the deaf man”, say “the man who is deaf.” Focus is on the person rather than disability.

- a. Use euphemistic expressions.
- b. Gender neutral language.
- c. Practise politeness.

*“Know yourself
and
Know your Audience.”
-Tennessee Ernie Ford*

Thank You!

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Lecture 08: Content Creation and Organization

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Sources for Content Creation

Library Research- With the flux caused by Internet, the value of library has been belittled because everything is just **one click away**. However, people fail to realize that libraries are indispensable and extremely resourceful. Some of the features are listed below:

- ❑ **Librarians-** People usually refrain from troubling a person in a silent library but librarians are taught to cater to our requirements when it comes to books and locating sources.



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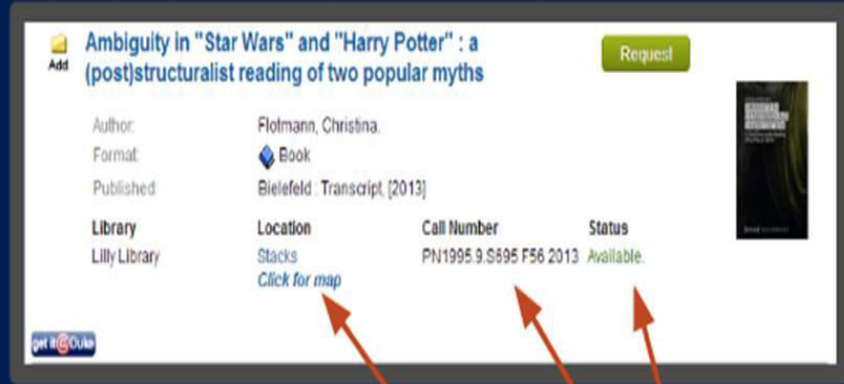


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- ❑ **Periodical Database-** This allows to locate magazine and journal articles. After obtaining the citations of the desired articles, one can request and download the full article if the library has access to it. In some cases, however, only abstracts are available and one should never cite an article on the basis of the abstract alone.

- ❑ **The Catalogue-** Lists all the books in a library along with their availability status. One can find books using limited information like name of the book or author or publisher or year of publication.

There are 3 important things you need to know:



1. Location of the book within the library*
2. Call number (the book's "address")
3. Whether or not the book is available

*Many libraries will have something similar to the "click for map" link to pull up a map of the exact location

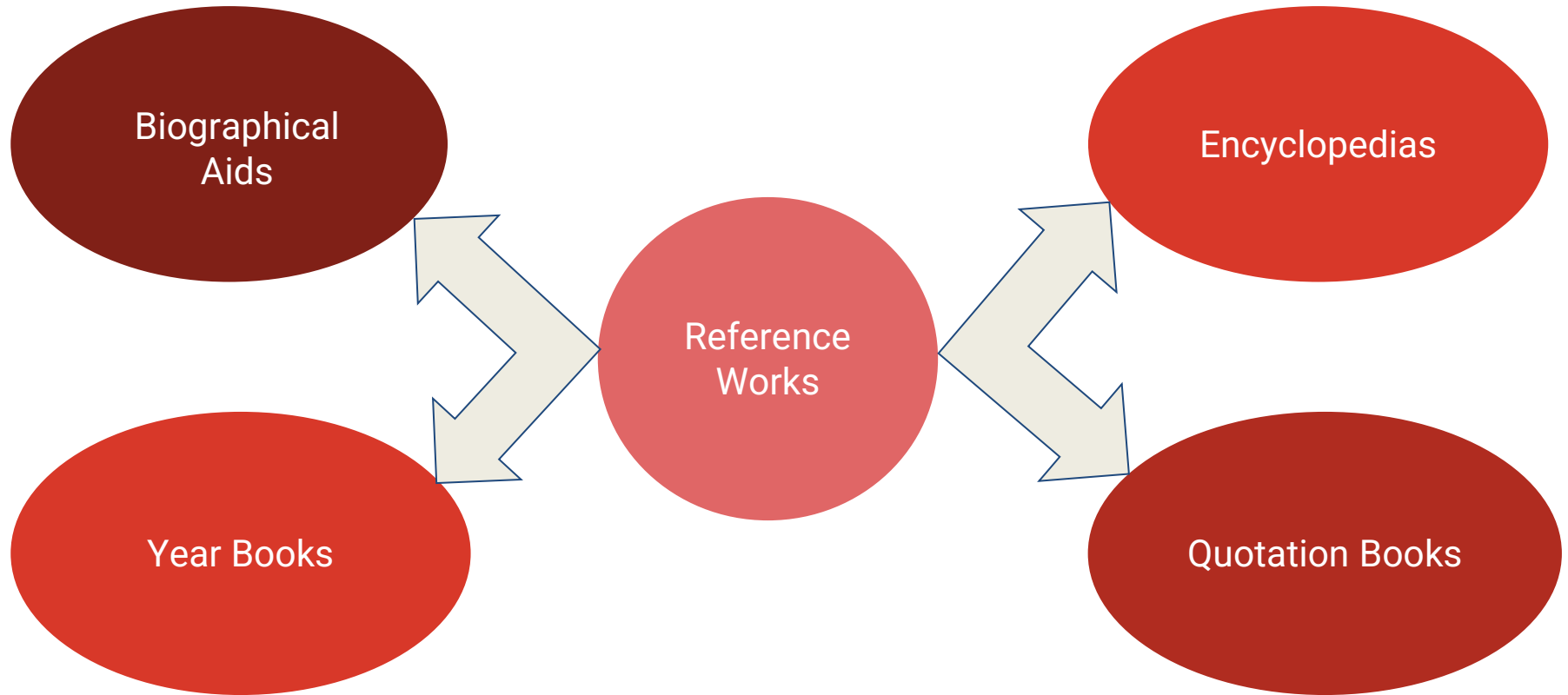
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- ❑ **Newspapers-** They are invaluable for research on diverse topics- historical, contemporary, opinionated, debatable. Every significant information about trivial incidents finds a dedicated column in newspaper.



Capitalizing on Personal Knowledge

- ❑ In order to bring any speech/talk/presentation to life, one must add personal touch to the knowledge. For example, a cancer survivor can explain what it is to live with a disease growing inside.
- ❑ Any speech is required to have colour and emotion where experience plays an exemplary role.
- ❑ It does not necessarily have to be dramatic or heart-wrenching; personal angle can act as an efficient support for the intended message.



SPECIALISED RESEARCH RESOURCES

Virtual Libraries

Search engines enable us to find what's on the Internet

Specialists segregate authentic information as everything is not true on Internet.

Government Resources

Access to Government documents and publications

Besides confidential information, one can find almost every document on Internet.

Multicultural Resources

Internet allows access to diverse and multicultural dimensions

There are multiple sites catering to the multicultural diversity cohabiting this world.

Evaluation of Internet Documents

Internet is a good slave but a bad master. As the documents on Internet exist electronically, one may find difficulty in distinguishing jewels from junk on internet. One should verify the following:

- ☐ Authorship
- ☐ Sponsorship
- ☐ Recency

Create an Outline

- Unlike a formal written outline, speaking outline is solely developed through keyword and phrases which highlights the main ideas.
- A formal written outline of the whole speech/talk is fairly condensed again when it is made as a speaking outline.
- The condensed outline for speaking is later laid out in small cards for access while presentation.
- Speaking cards helps to make a fluent and timely presentation.

Preparing Notes

- ❖ Prepare a speech/talk outline using separate headings and subheadings for ease of access and memory.
- ❖ The prepared outline should contain brief notes straight to the point.
- ❖ Add cues on the outline for remembering the intended pauses, silences, loud portions, and even the usage of visual aids while public speaking.
- ❖ Make sure that the prepared outline notes are legible for later reference.
- ❖ Most importantly, Practice repetitively with the prepared speaking notes.

Cue-cards for Memory (Signposting)

1. Breakdown your content into parts/ ideas.
2. Identify keywords.
3. Highlight each card (4x6 inch) with the main idea as the title.
4. Number the cards as per the order of the larger content.
5. Print/ write in clear, larger and legible font.
6. Color-codes comes handy to spot necessary cues.



Supporting the Content

The content prepared should be loaded with ample evidential support for the speaker to be able to persuade audience successfully.

Such a supportive speech can be provided through :

- ❖ Examples
- ❖ Explanations
- ❖ Statistics
- ❖ Analogies
- ❖ Testimony

Continued...

Apart from the supportive elements discussed, a public speaker can also avail technical and external support to fulfill his/her speech.

The external aids are as follows:

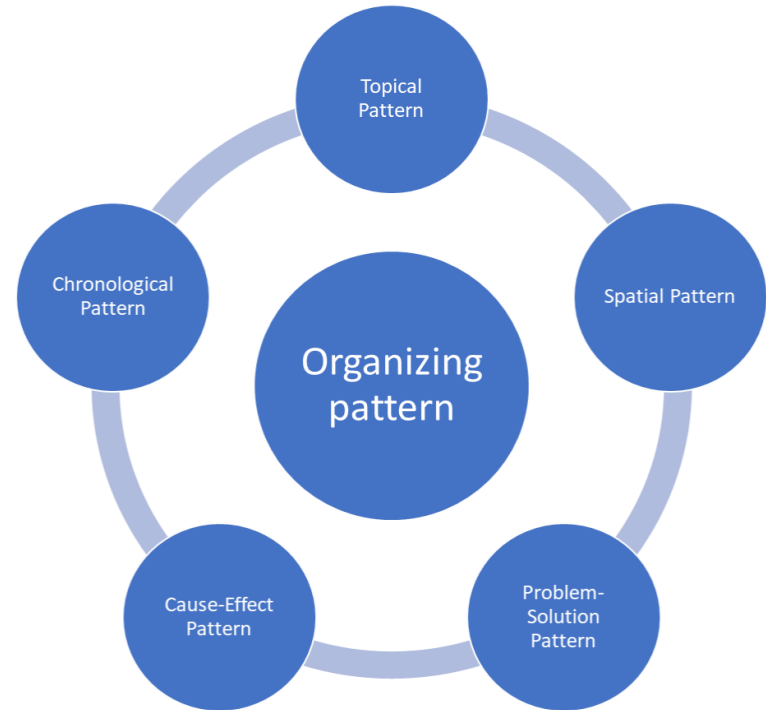
1. Objects
2. Posters and Handouts
3. Visual Aids
4. Pictures, Diagrams, Ideograms
5. Graphs, Charts and Tables
6. Video
7. Powerpoint Presentation



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Organization the Content

- ✓ The whole content could be deconstructed into a collection of main points.
- ✓ The task of a public speaker lies in organizing the procured content from various sources into a curated collection.
- ✓ There are many organizing patterns suggested for organizing content for public speaking.



Monroe's Motivated Sequence for Persuasive Presentations

Grab attention

Define the need

Satisfy the need

Visualize the solution

Call to action

Every speech ought to be put
together like a living creature
- Plato

Thank You

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Lecture 09: Role of Personality in Public Speaking

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Personality may be defined as the most characteristic integration of an individual's structures, modes of interests, attitude, behaviour, capacities, abilities and aptitudes.

(NL Munn)

“ A healthy personality is a process, not a state of being; a direction, not a destination.”

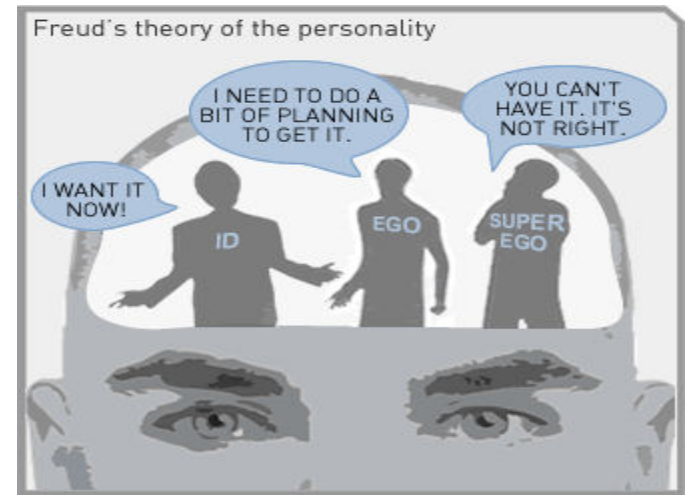
What is Personality?

- ❑ 'Personality': Etymology – Derived from the Latin word *persona*, which means mask.
- ❑ It comprises a comprehensive set of attributes:
 - Physique
 - Dress
 - Communication Skills
 - Attitude
 - Values
 - Emotions



Psychic Attributes of Personality

- According to Sigmund Freud's psychoanalytic theory, the human personality is governed by three distinct interacting agents of the psychic apparatus: Id, Ego and the Superego.



Id

- The primitive and instinctual part of the mind.
- Contains aggressive drives, desires and memories.
- Operates through Pleasure Principle.

Ego

- Mediates between the desires of Id and the Superego.
- Operates through Reality Principle.

Superego

- Inhibits the impulses of Id and persuades the Ego to strive for moralistic ideals.
- Operates as a moral conscience.

Personality and Public Speaking

- Speech is perceived as a form of self-expression.



- When a speaker communicates his ideas, he unintentionally reveals his personality, emotions and attitude.
- ***“Speech and personality grow, develop, differentiate and become refined together. Speech is a phase of personality.” - Elwood Murray***

Personality and Speech Proficiency: A Correlational Study

- Empirical evidences suggest that personality variables influence the speech proficiency of an individual.
- An instance can be cited -
 - **Premise:** Oration requires both short-term as well as long-term memory.
 - **Hypothesis:** Extroverts possess short-term memory whereas introverts are do well at long-term recall.
 - **Conclusion:** Extroverts excel at speech production which stems from their superior verbal processing capacity induced from their ability to short-term recall.
- Certain distinguishing traits, for instance; self-confidence, extraversion, intelligence, verbal fluency and composure go into the personality make-up of a competent speaker.
- Speech, therefore, reflects the personality of the speaker.



PERSONALITY TRAITS OF THE SPEAKER



INTRINSIC WORTH OF THE SPEAKER
(established by the personality traits)



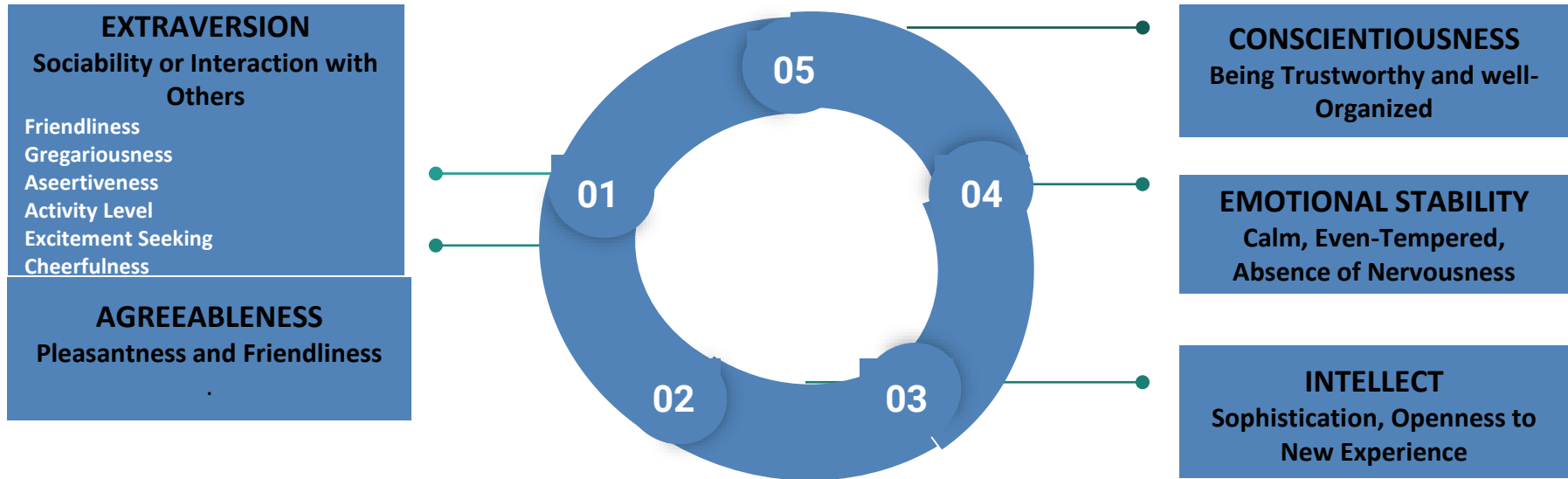
POSITIVE RESPONSE FROM THE AUDIENCE
(stimulated by the intrinsic worth)



EFFICIENT PUBLIC SPEAKER

The Five-Factor Model

McCrae and Costa have forwarded an all-inclusive **Five-Factor Model** (FFM) for the categorisation of the global personality traits.



Does Personality impact Public Speaking?

- ❑ The personality of the speaker in toto - intrinsic traits, appearance, voice, movements, diction - go into the modelling of a proficient speaker.
- ❑ **Sarett and Foster**, in their book *Basic Principles of Speech*, outline the vital impact of the following personality traits on the skill of oration:
 - ❑ **Extraversion**: A public speaker is required to be extrovert, sociable and objective in order to cast an influence on the audience.
 - ❑ **Agreeableness**: A pleasant and friendly attitude of the speaker helps to win over the audience.



- ❑ **Conscientiousness:** Being trustworthy and well-organized procures credibility to the speaker.
- ❑ **Emotional Stability:** An impactful speaker ought to manifest emotional maturity and keep up a composed bearing while delivering a speech.
- ❑ **Intellect:** As the thumb rule goes, intellectuals possessing the faculty of critical thinking and knowledgeable ideas emerge as better speakers.
- ❑ **Self-Confidence:** Like in all other avenues, in Public Speaking too, self-confidence is the key to success.

- ❑ **Fluency:** Verbal fluency and adept communicative skill is fundamental to convey speaker's ideas and emotions without any confusion.
- ❑ **Vocals:** The appropriate use of voice, volume, tone, and pauses helps to communicate nuances of speaker's emotion and thoughts, adding weight to the ideas presented.
- ❑ **Presentability:** Attractive personality of the speaker - groomed up appearance, well-donned clothes, kempt hair and a confident smile - aids in captivating the attention of the audience towards a greater acceptability of the speaker and his/her message.
- ❑ **Integrity:** Personal integrity of the speaker and a positive attitude towards life and society plays an important role in audience stimulation and thereby adds to the acclaim of the speaker.



PUBLIC SPEAKER: SPEECH ATTITUDE				PUBLIC SPEAKER: PERSONALITY
1	I am ill at ease when speaking with a group	✗	✓	Are you talkative at social gatherings?
2	I enjoy meeting and talking with famous people.	✓	✗	Do you feel self-conscious in the presence of superiors?
3	I enjoy making a speech in a large auditorium.	✓	✗	Do you find it difficult to speak in public?
4	I find it easy to solicit money for a cause which interests me.	✓	✗	Are you troubled with shyness?
5	I hesitate to protest even though I feel I have been wronged.	✗	✓	Do you try to get your own way even if you have to fight for it?

Categories of Public Speakers and their Personality Traits

CATEGORY OF PUBLIC SPEAKER	PERSONALITY TRAITS
AVOIDER	Does everything possible to escape from facing an audience. Is generally an introvert.
RESISTOR	Has fear of speaking in public. Is a reluctant individual.
ACCEPTOR	Gives presentations occasionally as part of the job. Doesn't seek those opportunities.
SEEKER	Looks for opportunities to speak in public Is usually a confident extrovert who can effectively overcome anxiety and the fear of speaking in public.

Do's and Don'ts of Personal Appearance

Do

- ❖ Stay close, stay direct, stay involved with your audience.
- ❖ Use your facial expressions.
- ❖ Vary your pitch, volume and tone in your voice.

Don't

- ❖ Keep hands in your pocket
- ❖ Keep your arms crossed
- ❖ Wring your hands nervously
- ❖ Have too soft voice - Lack of confidence
- ❖ Make too loud voice - Excessively dominant

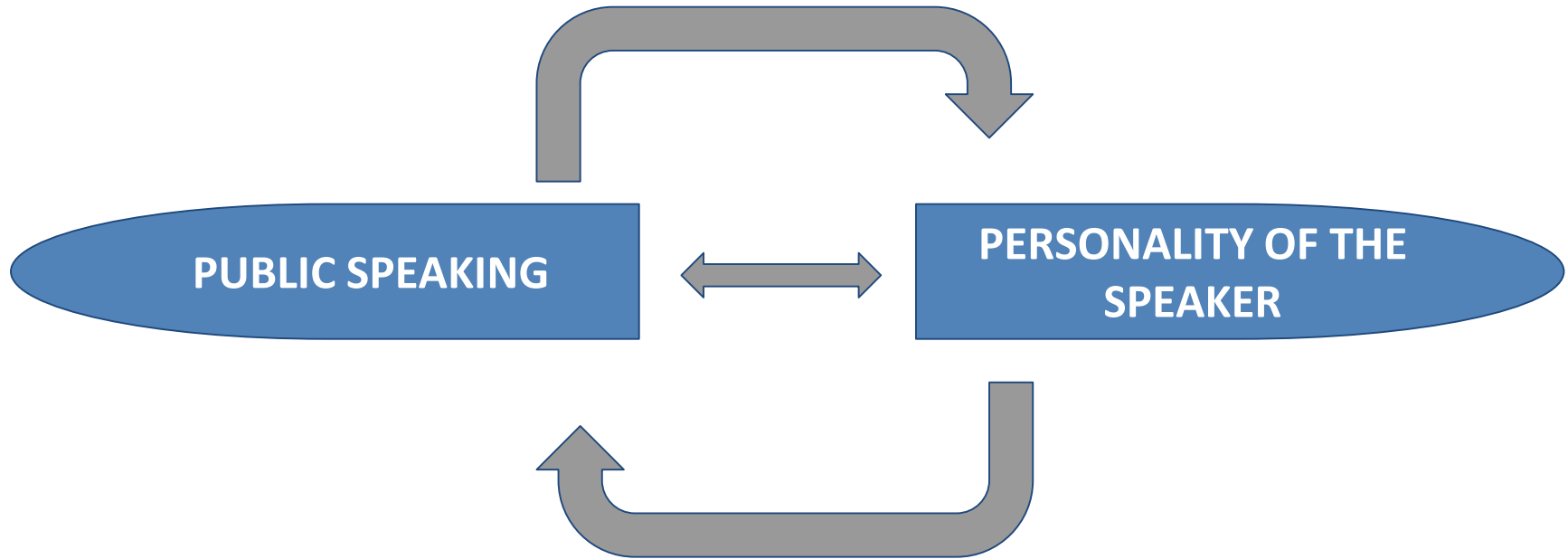
Do

- ❖ Keep your posture erect.
- ❖ Maintain good eye contact with different parts of the audience.
- ❖ Watch your conversational pace.
- ❖ Allow pauses during the presentation.
- ❖ Encourage your audience to ask questions.

Don't

- ❖ Posture should not be stiff or unnatural.
- ❖ Eye contact should not be too long to make the person feel uncomfortable (3 to 5 seconds per person).
- ❖ Avoid too tight or too loose clothing, sparkling jewelry, heavy make-up, tinted lenses.

Public Speaking and Personality: An Inter-Relational Continuum



- Personality of the speaker and the skill of Public Speaking are complementary to each other - proficiency at speech possesses a strong correlation with the speaker's personality traits.
- These two flourish simultaneously and mutually, interacting aspects of the individual's holistic development.
- Speech, as per scholar Eisenson, is a reflection of speaker's experiences in entirety - innate as well as environmental.
- The efficiency of Public Speaking is directly proportional to the development of personality of the speaker. Hence, they are integral to and constitutive of each other.



Personality Traits developed by Public Speaking

- ✓ Better Thinkers
- ✓ Confident Individuals
- ✓ Proficient Communicators
- ✓ Reliable Beings
- ✓ Assertive Leaders
- ✓ High Emotional Quotient



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*“What you are speaks so loud, I cannot hear
what you say.”*

W. T. Foster

Thank You





IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 10: Use of Technology in Public Speaking

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Advent of Technology in Public Speaking

- **Print Age** - The advent of printing press in Europe around mid 1400's led to a revolution in the world of intellectuals - generating larger amount of data for thought, *speech* and action.
- **Audio-visual age** - In the late nineteenth century, wireless means of transmission came into effect. Telegraphs, telephones, radios and later television broadcast enabled for massive transmission of message.
- **Internet and Digital Age:** Live broadcast of message through Internet stream provides seamless connection for students, staff members and almost every other person leading to a “new-normal”.

Technology in Public Speaking

- In public speaking, one's own voice is the preliminary tool which can be supplemented by other tools for enhancement of the message's effect.
- **However, the strength of the message is more important than the strength of the channel.**
- Heavy reliance on technological aid might lead to distraction and even distortion of cause & effect.
- A good public speaker must know to keep the right balance on when to use technology and when to keep it otherwise.

Technological Tools for Public Speaking

- In public speaking, a variety of tools are employed by a speaker to channelize and communicate.
- ❖ Microphone
- ❖ Speakers
- ❖ Teleprompter
- ❖ Presentation Timer
- ❖ Projector
- ❖ Projector Screen



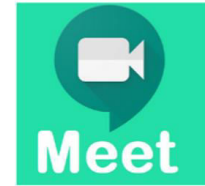
Technological Apps for Public Speaking

Apart from the hardware support, there are countless apps available for enhancing, checking and correcting the delivery and nuances of your speech.

1. Video-conferencing apps
 - a. Zoom
 - b. Google Meet
 - c. Webex
 - d. MS Teams
2. Teleprompter apps
3. Timer apps
4. Public Speaking Practise apps.

Eg. Orai

1. Grammar-check apps



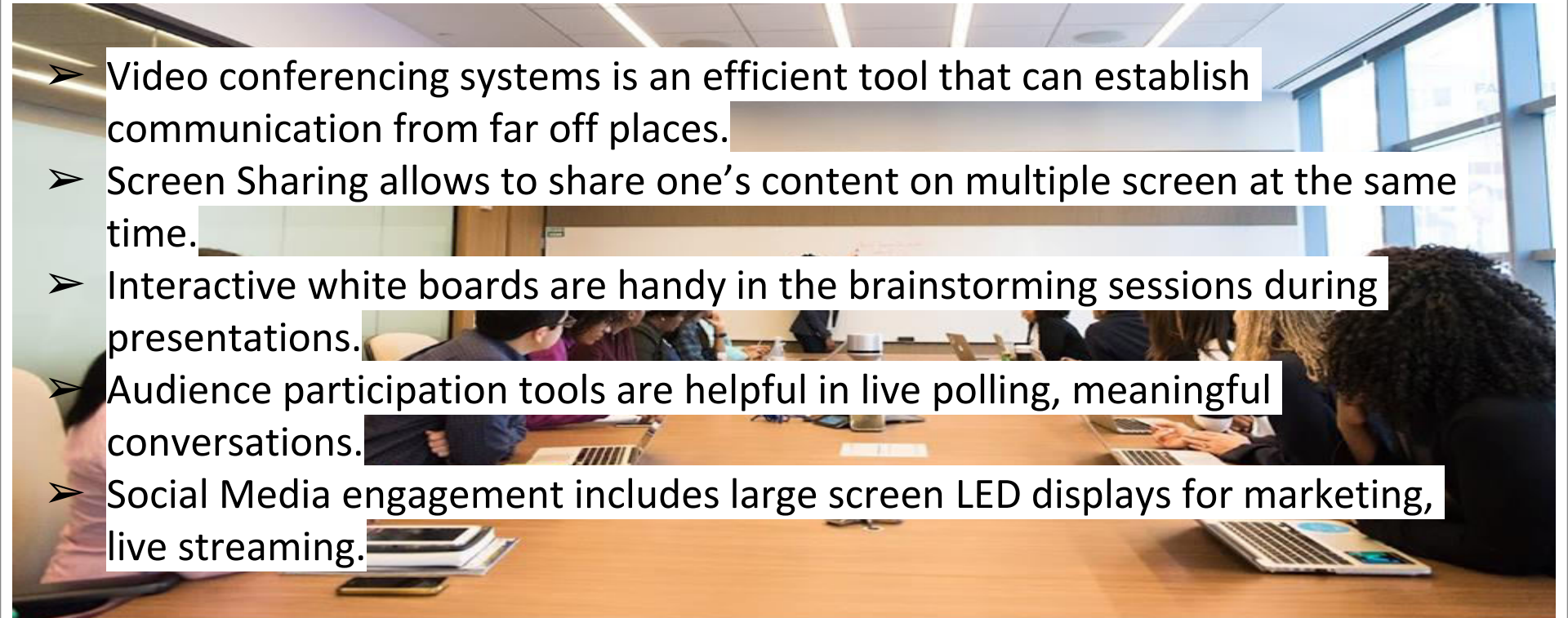
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Bringing Technology into Classroom

- It enhances student-learning experience
- Use of technology fosters student engagement for auditory and visual learning.
- Integration of simple and effective technologies like Power Point Presentations, filmed demonstrations, Internet homework assignments can mark great difference in the student's growth in the classroom.
- It incorporates diverse learning styles
- Improves Collaboration
- Prepares everyone for the future



Bringing Technology into Meeting

- 
- Video conferencing systems is an efficient tool that can establish communication from far off places.
 - Screen Sharing allows to share one's content on multiple screen at the same time.
 - Interactive white boards are handy in the brainstorming sessions during presentations.
 - Audience participation tools are helpful in live polling, meaningful conversations.
 - Social Media engagement includes large screen LED displays for marketing, live streaming.

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Role of Technology at Events



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- Having a responsive website
- Apps can be built to cater to the queries and ease of the intended audience
- Social Media has a great reach so it could be used for publicity
- Virtual experiences have been trending and gain a lot of engagement from the audience
- Proper use of light can really set the desired mood for the event
- Polls and surveys for feedback

Technological Distractions

Technology can hamper the speech output of the public speaker.

- The channel can become a barrier for effective listening.
- Old malfunctioning hardware can steal time and even falter your speech into a blurred noise.
- Wireless communication can get unstable at times due to lower bandwidth etc. Preparing backup support is integral.
- Excessive usage of audio-visual aids should be checked. The speaker should talk for the larger part and not the material.

Tips to Overcome Technological Distractions

- **Test run:** The public speaker must arrive early for the presentation and make sure of the proper functioning of the technological tools given at hand.
- **Sound check:** To make sure that voice is channelized loud and clear.
- **Noise cancellation:** Any source of noise or distractions such as cellphones, unruly audience etc should be checked and regulated.
- **Setting up the room:** The speaker shall request audience to comply and provide a distraction-free environment.
- **Balanced AV stimulation:** A speaker should provide a balance to audience on what they see and hear.

Public Speaking at Online Platforms

- Digressing from the face-to-face, **digital oratory** or online public speaking is a “thesis-driven, vocal, embodied public address that is housed within (online) new media platforms” (Lind, 2012, p. 164).
- It should be well-organized, reasoned and rehearsed.

The key roles in digital oratory are played by-

- Purpose**
- Synchronicity**
- Audience**



Digital Oratory

Virtual Meetings



- ❑ One should be comfortable and responsive.
- ❑ **Passion** is essential for engaging sessions at the time of delivery, questions and observations.
- ❑ **Voice modulation** plays a pivotal role- it can either kill or gain attention.

- ❑ Setting up equipments properly is essential.
- ❑ Choose your platform (YouTube, Facebook, etc.)
- ❑ Test Run is essential
- ❑ Go Live!



Live Streaming

What is Webinar?

According to Merriam-Webster, a webinar (or web seminar) is “a live online educational presentation during which participating viewers can submit questions and comments.”

Webinar is essential because it -

- Educates the audience about business.
- Builds authority in one's industry or niche.
- Demonstrates one's product to customers.
- Generates leads for one's business.
- It is used for academic purposes as well.

Importance and Challenges of Online Public Speaking

Importance of Online Public Speaking:

- ☐ Career Advancements
- ☐ Boosts Confidence
- ☐ Improves Communication Skills

Challenges of Online Public Speaking:

- ☐ Technical Limitations
- ☐ Loss of Interpersonal interactions
- ☐ Opportunity for Distractions

**“Let thy speech be better than silence, or
be silent.”**

-Dionysius Of Halicarnassus

Thank You

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